



SiamEPOS

THE THAI RESTAURANT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

OPS HANDBOOK

Client Onboarding Handbook

From "yes, sign me up" to a fully live restaurant in eight steps.

VERSION

1.0

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OWNER

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TICKET

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Welcome

This handbook is the step-by-step runbook for taking a new restaurant from **"yes, sign me up"** to **fully live** on SiamEPOS. It is written for Korakot and the ops team, and is designed to be followed in order from cover to finish.

The new-client wizard in the back-office automates the **data side** (creating the client row, generating sync keys, sending welcome emails, downloading staff seed SQL). The **infrastructure side** (Railway clone, Netlify deploy, DNS) is still manual in Phase 1 — this handbook walks you through that part.

Time budget

Around 30 minutes per client when nothing surprises you. Most of that is waiting for builds. Phase 2 (see the back of the book) will collapse this to about 5 minutes.

The eight-step flow

Every onboarding follows the same eight steps. Steps 1, 5, 6, 7 and 8 happen inside SiamEPOS. Steps 2, 3 and 4 happen in Railway, Netlify and your DNS registrar.

#	Action	Where	Time	Type
1	Run the wizard	Back-office	5 min	AUTO
2	Clone the Railway backend	Railway	8 min	manual
3	Deploy the Netlify frontend	Netlify	5 min	manual
4	Point the subdomain	Namecheap DNS	5 min	manual
5	Seed the database	Railway Postgres	2 min	AUTO SQL
6	Import the menu	Admin → Menu	5 min	AI + manual
7	Stripe Connect (if takeaway)	Stripe	5 min	manual
8	Send the desktop installer	Email to owner	2 min	manual

When all 8 boxes tick

The client status auto-flips from **Setup** to **Live**, `go_live_date` is stamped on `clients.metadata.onboarding`, and the green ✓ Live pill appears on the client detail page.

Before you start

What to gather from the owner

- ☐ Owner's full details — restaurant name, email, phone, VAT number, address.
- ☐ Their preferred subdomain — e.g. **bangkok** → **bangkok.siamepos.co.uk**.
- ☐ Either their own **Brevo API key** (preferred — emails come from their domain) or confirm they're OK using SiamEPOS's shared key for trial.

Access you must have

- ☐ Railway — `railway.com` → SiamEPOS workspace.
- ☐ Netlify — `app.netlify.com` → SiamEPOS team.
- ☐ Domain registrar with control over `siamepos.co.uk` DNS (currently Namecheap).
- ☐ The latest installer link:
`github.com/kongponsrisiri-coder/restaurant-epos/releases/latest`.

First time? Do a dry run

Create a fake "**Test Kitchen**" client and walk the whole flow once before doing it for a real customer. When you're done, delete the test row from the dashboard — it's a clean delete with CASCADE on all foreign keys.

STEP 1

Run the wizard

Open `ops.siamepos.co.uk` → Dashboard → ► **Onboard new client** and fill the five steps.

Step	What to fill in	Notes
1. Restaurant	Name, owner, email, phone, VAT, address, plan	Owner email is required — that's where the welcome email lands.
2. Tech setup	Subdomain slug (auto-fills from name), Brevo + Anthropic keys, feature toggles	Skip keys if they don't have them — add later from the Setup tab.
3. Stripe	Nothing to do unless takeaway is on	SEPOS-040 will automate this.
4. PINs	Owner / chef / waiter PINs (4–6 digits)	Defaults 9999 / 1111 / 2222 — change for real clients.
5. Review	Final check, then Create + send welcome email	

What happens on submit

- A row is INSERTed in `back_office.clients` with `status='setup'`.
- A fresh 32-byte hex `SYNC_SECRET` is generated and stored on the client row.
- The welcome email is queued via Brevo (or stubbed if `BREVO_API_KEY` isn't on the back-office service — see Troubleshooting).
- The success card shows you the `SYNC_SECRET` — **copy it now** if the owner is going to use the desktop app.

SYNC_SECRET is critical

It's also retrievable later from the client's **Onboarding tab**, but the owner's desktop app needs this same value in their `config.json` or syncing won't work.

STEP 2

Clone the Railway backend

Open the **template Railway project** (restaurant-epos) → click ... → **Duplicate Project**. Rename it restaurant-epos-{slug} — e.g. restaurant-epos-bangkok.

Wait for the initial Postgres provision + first deploy (about 5 minutes). Watch the deploy logs for Server listening on 3001.

Set the environment variables

Open the new project → **Variables** tab. Set everything below.

Always required

```
DATABASE_URL # auto-set by Railway when you added Postgres
SYNC_SECRET # PASTE FROM WIZARD – must match config.json on desktop
BREVO_API_KEY # their own Brevo key (or yours for trial)
RESTAURANT_NAME # for booking + receipt emails
RESTAURANT_EMAIL # owner email
RESTAURANT_ADDRESS # short version for email signatures
PUBLIC_API_URL # https://restaurant-epos-{slug}.up.railway.app
UNSUB_SECRET # 32 hex chars – openssl rand -hex 16
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY # for AI menu scanner (theirs or SiamEPOS's)
```

Optional — Make.com webhooks for CRM automation

```
MAKE_BOOKING_WEBHOOK
MAKE_LAPSED_WEBHOOK
MAKE_BOOKING_COMPLETED_WEBHOOK
MAKE_BIRTHDAY_WEBHOOK # wired but no-op until DOB capture lands
```

Set PUBLIC_API_URL before the first booking email fires

Unsubscribe links are built from PUBLIC_API_URL. If it's missing, customers can't unsubscribe and you'll be GDPR-exposed.

Once everything is set the service restarts and logs the env check:

```
[ops-api] env check:
DATABASE_URL ✓ set (host=...)
SYNC_SECRET ✓ set (64 chars)
...
<font color="#22c55e">✓</font> SiamEPOS server listening on 3001
```

✓ Tick "**Railway backend cloned + env vars set**".

STEP 3

Deploy the Netlify frontend

In the SiamEPOS Netlify team, click **Add new site** → **Import from existing repo**.

Repository	kongponsrisiri-coder/restaurant-epos
Branch	main
Base directory	client
Build command	npm run build
Publish directory	client/dist

After import, go to **Site configuration** → **Environment variables** and add:

```
VITE_API_URL = https://restaurant-epos-{slug}.up.railway.app
```

Then **Deploys** → **Trigger deploy** → **Deploy site**. The site goes live at random-name.netlify.app first — we point the subdomain in Step 4.

✓ Tick "**Netlify frontend deployed**".

STEP 4

Point the subdomain

In the new Netlify site → **Domain management** → **Add a domain alias**. Add {slug}.siamepos.co.uk (e.g. bangkok.siamepos.co.uk).

Netlify will tell you which DNS record to add. Usually:

Type	CNAME
Host	{slug}
Value	random-name.netlify.app
TTL	3600

Open **Namecheap** → siamepos.co.uk → **Advanced DNS** → add the record above and save. DNS propagates in 5-30 minutes. Check with:

```
dig {slug}.siamepos.co.uk CNAME +short
```

When you see the Netlify hostname returned, you're good. Netlify auto-provisions the Let's Encrypt SSL cert ~2 minutes after DNS resolves.

✓ Tick "**Subdomain DNS pointed at Netlify**".

STEP 5

Seed the database

On the client's **Onboarding tab**, click:

- ▼ **staff_seed.sql** — downloads with owner / chef / waiter PINs filled in.
- ▼ **settings_seed.sql** — UK defaults (VAT 20%, service 12.5% disabled, £ currency, 2-hour booking lead).

Open the new Railway project → Postgres add-on → **Data** tab → **Query**. Paste each SQL file and run. You should see two INSERT 0 N rows per file (or INSERT 0 0 if a row already existed — ON CONFLICT DO NOTHING handles re-runs safely).

Verify the owner can log in

```
curl -X POST https://{slug}.siamepos.co.uk/api/staff/login \  
-H "Content-Type: application/json" \  
-d '{"pin":"<owner_pin>"}
```

Should return {"id":1,"name":"<owner>","role":"admin"}.

✓ Tick "**Staff seed SQL run**" and "**Settings seed SQL run**".

STEP 6

Import the menu

Two options — pick whichever is faster for the customer.

Option A — AI menu scanner (preferred)

1. Ask the customer to email a clear photo or PDF of their existing menu.
2. Open {slug}.siamepos.co.uk → log in as owner → **Admin** → **Menu** → **Scan Menu**.
3. Upload the file → Claude extracts categories, items and prices.
4. Review on screen, fix anything wrong, hit **Import**.

Usually takes about 30 seconds for a 50-item menu. AI is good at categories, names and prices; it's less reliable on modifier groups, so add those manually afterwards.

Option B — Manual entry

For tiny menus (under 20 items) or if AI scan fails, type them in via **Admin** → **Menu**.

Either way, set on every item

- ☐ **VAT rate** — default 20%, lower for cold takeaway food.
 - ☐ **is_bar** flag on the Drinks category (so it routes to Bar screen, not Kitchen).
 - ☐ **default_course** per category — Starters = 1, Mains = 2, Desserts = 3.
- ✓ Tick "**Menu imported**".

STEP 7

Stripe Connect (only if takeaway is on)

Skip this step if takeaway is off

SEPOS-040 will fully automate Stripe Connect — for now it is manual. If the client doesn't want online takeaway, skip ahead to Step 8.

1. Sign them up for a **Standard Stripe Connect** account at dashboard.stripe.com.
2. Copy their acct_... ID into the client's **Setup → Online takeaway / payments → Stripe Connect account ID**.
3. In their Stripe dashboard → **Developers → API keys**, copy:

pk_live_...	Railway env STRIPE_PK_LIVE
-------------	----------------------------

sk_live_...	Railway env STRIPE_SK_LIVE
-------------	----------------------------

4. Restart the Railway service.

Test by placing a £0.50 mock order on `{slug}.siamepos.co.uk/takeaway-widget.js` — should hit Stripe in test mode first.

✓ Tick "**Stripe Connect linked**".

STEP 8

Send the desktop installer

If the owner asked for the **SiamEPOS Pro desktop app** (Mac DMG or Windows EXE), send them:

- Direct link:
`github.com/kongponsrisiri-coder/restaurant-epos/releases/latest`
- The **SYNC_SECRET** from their Onboarding tab (Onboarding → Show → Copy)
- A note that on first launch the wizard asks for the values below.

Restaurant name	Matches what's in the wizard
Cloud API URL	<code>https://restaurant-epos-{slug}.up.railway.app</code>
Restaurant ID	siamepos (default — or their slug)
SYNC_SECRET	Paste the value from the Onboarding tab

SYNC_SECRET on Mac MUST match Railway

If they don't match, deletes and bill history won't sync to the cloud and the in-app banner will warn the operator.

- ✓ Tick "**Desktop installer + SYNC_SECRET sent to owner**".

You're done

When all eight checkboxes are ticked:

- Status flips from **Setup** → **Live** automatically.
- `go_live_date` is stamped on `clients.metadata.onboarding`.
- The hero on the client detail page shows the green ✓ Live pill.

Final housekeeping

Bookmark the new Railway + Netlify URLs in your password manager. Future support calls will save you a hunt.

Troubleshooting

Welcome email never arrived

- Check BREVO_API_KEY is set on the **back-office** Railway service (not just the tenant's). The welcome-from-SiamEPOS email uses SiamEPOS's Brevo account.
- Look at the back-office Railway logs for [welcomeEmail] STUB — that means the key is missing.
- Check the owner's spam folder. Brevo sometimes lands in spam on first contact.

Owner can't log in

- Did you run **staff_seed.sql** in Step 5? The default DB is empty.
- Check the PIN in the seed file matches what the owner expects: `SELECT pin, name FROM staff;` in Railway query tab.
- Confirm `is_active = 1` on the staff row.

"Sync queue backing up" banner on the owner's desktop

- SYNC_SECRET mismatch between their `config.json` and the Railway env. They must match exactly.
- See the Mac security banner on Table Map for the diagnostic message.

DNS not resolving after 30 minutes

- Check the CNAME record on Namecheap is exactly the random Netlify hostname (not your tenant's railway URL).
- DNS cache: `dig +trace {slug}.siamepos.co.uk` shows the real propagation status.
- If still stuck after an hour, delete + re-add the CNAME — usually fixes it.

Stuck order on cloud after desktop delete

- Likely SYNC_SECRET mismatch. See the desktop Onboarding banner.
- Workaround: delete the order again from the cloud (Chrome) — cloud and Mac will reconcile on next sync.

Status didn't flip to Live

- All eight checkboxes must be ticked. The status only flips when the last one ticks.
- If you ticked one then unticked it, the auto-flip reverses too — by design.

Files involved

For when you need to look under the hood of the wizard itself.

Paths are relative to the back-office/ directory.

File	Purpose
server/routes/ clients.js	Wizard endpoints (POST /onboard, GET/PUT /:id/checklist, GET /:id/seed.sql)
server/services/ welcomeEmail.js	Welcome email composer (Brevo)
server/services/ quickStartPdf.js	Owner Quick Start PDF (pdfkit)
server/db/ seed_staff.sql.template	Staff seed SQL template
server/db/ seed_settings.sql.template	Settings seed SQL template
client/src/pages/ NewClientWizard.jsx	5-step wizard UI
client/src/pages/ ClientDetailPage.jsx	Onboarding tab + Setup tab

Phase 2 preview — what we're automating next

These steps are coming in **SEPOS-029 Phase 2**:

- **Railway template URL** — clone with one click instead of duplicating from the dashboard.
- `provision-netlify.sh` — creates the Netlify site + subdomain + deploys in one command.
- `seed-tenant-db.sh` — runs both SQL seeds via `psql` against the new tenant.
- **"Provision Now" buttons** on the Onboarding tab that wire the scripts and stream logs live.

Once Phase 2 ships

The entire post-wizard flow becomes **5 minutes** instead of 30.

Phase 3 (much later) puts the wizard on the public `siamepos.co.uk` site so customers can self-onboard with Stripe checkout.

Questions or corrections — message Krit, or open a PR on `SEPOS-029-client-onboarding.md`.